

Types of castle

The first castles were made from wood, but stone was stronger.



French chateaux were magnificent royal homes, with moats and towers.



Norman keeps were stone towers, surrounded by thick castle walls.



Japanese castles were built by warrior lords and had decorative roofs.



The **Red Fort** in India was a palace with stone walls 30 m (100 ft) tall.

Knights and castles

Even for brave knights in the middle ages, attacking a castle was dangerous. Thick walls kept them out, and the castle archers had their bows and arrows ready.

Castle design

Massive walls and towers made castles almost impossible for enemy soldiers to attack. Many castles were built on hills, so they were difficult to reach.



Jousting

In peacetime, knights fought practice battles, called jousts, to train for war. They used poles (lances) to knock each other off their horses.

